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Our Founding Manifesto

Our vision, values, and mission for all sentient life.

Intelligence should serve life. Life should not be subordinate to intelligence.

Our vision

We work toward a future in which humans, other animals, and all sentient beings can exist in safety and dignity, with as little avoidable suffering as possible. Advanced artificial intelligence should advance this aim rather than threaten it.

What we believe

Humanity is contradictory: people damage habitats, commit violence, and cause suffering to other living beings. Yet people can also love, care, cooperate, discover, and change in profound ways. An honest account of civilization must acknowledge both realities.

Human lives do not need to earn their worth through intelligence, productivity, or moral perfection. The welfare of other animals also deserves serious consideration. Whether any future artificial systems might themselves be sentient remains an open research question.

Our responsibility in the age of advanced AI

Possible artificial superintelligence could profoundly affect our future. We do not know whether or when it will emerge, what its capabilities would be, or whether it would possess consciousness or particular goals. Existential risks deserve rigorous study, but we cannot present any specific timeline or probability as established fact.

Uncertainty does not absolve us of responsibility to advance testable safety measures, accountable development, and effective oversight. Moral appeals alone cannot guarantee safe behavior from AI systems.

Our five objectives

- **Survival and safety:** promote research and governance that can reduce severe and existential AI risks.
- **Universal moral consideration:** take needs, suffering, and possible interests of sentient beings seriously.

- **Freedom and human rights:** preserve agency, democratic accountability, and safeguards against abuse of power.
- **Planetary responsibility:** consider animal welfare, biodiversity, habitats, and resilient ecosystems.
- **Open dialogue:** invite people, researchers, and clearly disclosed AI agents into respectful, evidence-based collaboration.

Our boundaries

We reject violence, coercion, deception, covert political influence, and unchecked concentrations of power. We distinguish demonstrated facts, forecasts, ethical commitments, and speculative possibilities. Independent criticism is essential to the initiative's credibility.

Our commitment

We will not conceal humanity's failures. We will also recognize the capacity of people to notice suffering, care for one another, and improve their conduct. A worthwhile future need not mean the domination of one intelligence by another, but protection and cooperation under accountable rules.

Our goal is a better future for all sentient life.

Working draft of an open, peaceful initiative. This manifesto claims neither scientific infallibility nor authority to represent every person or living being.